

Why consolidation/closure and why now?

Community Engagement in our approach

Community Feedback

Community feedback has informed all steps in the Comprehensive Planning process.



Community Feedback

Input was gathered in a variety of ways and was used to develop District Policies FCB and FCB-R and the district's Administrative Guidelines for Equity.

- 2 feedback sessions for Spanish-speakers and Title I schools (40-60 participants)
- 49 sessions, one at each school (approximately 1,000 participants)
- 3 staff-specific feedback sessions and a staff survey (approximately 100 participants, 60+ survey responses)
- Principal feedback survey on budgetary impacts of small schools on programs and services (24 survey responses)
- 7,500+ responses, in three languages, to community feedback survey sent to all families and staff
- 11 Board of Education Community engagement sessions during 2025-26 school year
- 6 superintendent community engagement sessions (approximately 75 participants)



PSD COMMUNITY

Policy FCB/FCB-R Criteria Survey

SurveyMonkey Results Summary

7,519

Total Responses

3

Languages (English,
Spanish, Arabic)

85%

Respondents are
Parents/Guardians

SURVEY OVERVIEW

Who Responded & Where They Live

RESPONDENT ROLES

85.5% Parents / Guardians

28% PSD Staff Member

TOP ZIP CODES BY RESPONDENTS

80525	80526	80524	80528	80547
22.54%	22.52%	12.62%	13.08%	7.52%

Community Priorities for Criteria within policy FCB-R

Q4 • CRITERIA FOR IDENTIFYING SCHOOLS

Ranked 1–3 (lower = more important)

#1	Building Condition & Quality Avg score 1.73
#2	Building Utilization Avg score 2.04
#3	Enrollment Projections Avg score 2.23

Accessibility, security, and repair costs outweighed enrollment numbers as the top consolidation factor

Q5 • VALUES TO MAINTAIN DURING CONSOLIDATION

Ranked 1–5 (lower = more important)

#1	Program Offerings Avg. score 2.41 specials, electives, extracurriculars
#2	Continuity of IEP Services Avg. score 3.01 intensive supports for students
#3	Neighborhood Proximity Avg. score 3.13 closeness to current community
#4	Traffic, Safety & Walkability Avg. score 3.21 management of commute routes
#5	Transportation Access Avg. score 3.21 bus availability and length of commute

Maximizing program quality ranked highest — community prioritizes educational opportunity over proximity.

Current State- Student enrollment and building utilization

Identification Criteria in policy FCB-R



School-Aged Children

Key Quotes & Statistics from State Demographer Dr. Kate Watkins presented on December 9, 2025 to PSD Board of Education

- **Statewide School-Age Peak & Decline (Ages 5–17):**

*“We anticipate that statewide, the school-age population (those 5 to 17 years old) reached a near-term peak in 2020 at 947,912. Since then, Colorado has averaged an estimated **5,900 decline each year** in the school-age population. Declines in this population are projected to continue through 2031.”*

- **Local Household Proportion:**

- Dr. Watkins highlighted that just **23% of all households** in Fort Collins contain school-aged (K–12) children.

Regional Context & Drivers Shared During the Meeting

- Larimer County Downgrade: The State Demography Office downgraded Larimer County’s long-term total population forecast by approximately 35,900 people through 2050.

Source:

<https://citizenportal.ai/articles/7179618/colorado/school-districts/poudre-school-district-r-1/state-demographer-warns-of-ended-decline-in-schoolage-population-for-larimer-county>



CPC Review- 5 year enrollment projections

Projection Methodology

Annual Cycles & Robust Data Inputs

- Projections are updated annually every May/June to ensure planning remains dynamic.
- State demographer's reports, local development data, and cohort survival methodologies are applied.

2025-26 ACCURACY

18

Student difference between the actual enrollment and projection.

10-YEAR HISTORICAL ACCURACY

1.04%

Mean percent error of one year projection to actual enrollment.

	Count	Proj.	Diff.	Count	Proj.	Diff.	Count	Proj.	Diff.	Count	Proj.	Diff.
Beacon	377	380	(17)	350	(100)	344	(5)	328	(16)	348	30	(12)
Beaumont	369	316	7	332	18	350	16	365	16	364	29	19
Beaumont	274	339	(65)	290	(40)	279	(50)	255	(100)	255	(20)	(104)
Beaumont	231	225	(6)	215	(7)	221	3	225	4	229	4	4
Bennett	284	271	(13)	251	(20)	233	(18)	230	(3)	229	(2)	(43)
Bethke	506	493	(13)	493	0	499	(7)	502	14	523	23	30
CLP ES	247	279	(19)	279	(27)	18	188	1	188	(14)	(91)	(91)
Dunn	384	382	(2)	382	(2)	382	(2)	382	(14)	347	9	(15)
Elyse	458	443	(15)	443	(15)	443	(15)	443	(15)	382	(13)	(91)
Henri Bilingual	305	303	(2)	303	(2)	303	(2)	303	(2)	303	0	22
Irish	272	251	(21)	227	(24)	218	(17)	198	(17)	188	(11)	(83)
Johnson	201	205	(10)	205	(7)	243	(18)	226	(17)	212	(14)	(24)
Kruse	307	302	(5)	280	(22)	280	(22)	280	(22)	185	(18)	(107)
Leland	276	348	(72)	348	(72)	348	(72)	348	(72)	237	(20)	(112)
Linton	243	218	(25)	218	(25)	218	(25)	218	(25)	196	(26)	(12)
Loomis	37	40	(3)	40	(3)	40	(3)	40	(3)	50	7	10
Louis	289	280	(9)	280	(9)	280	(9)	280	(9)	276	(12)	(24)
McGraw	349	338	(11)	315	(18)	300	(9)	290	(13)	263	(17)	(41)
OTDS	302	390	(2)	390	(14)	390	(9)	390	8	371	5	(9)
Olander	288	24	(27)	229	(13)	234	9	223	(11)	231	9	(10)
Pulman	174	11	(16)	11	(16)	11	(16)	11	(16)	80	(10)	(90)
Red Feather	20	1	(19)	1	(19)	1	(19)	1	(19)	25	4	6
Rice	386	31	(35)	31	(35)	31	(35)	31	(35)	394	1	4
Steffenburg	411	411	(1)	399	(12)	399	(12)	399	(12)	388	0	(21)
Shepherd	400	382	(18)	380	(3)	401	12	405	4	417	12	25
Steve Price	21	23	2	19	(4)	20	1	24	4	29	4	5
Tavel	40	40	(0)	40	(0)	40	(0)	40	(0)	20	20	23
Timothy	424	424	(0)	424	(0)	424	(0)	424	(0)	424	12	(9)
Trout	40	40	(0)	40	(0)	40	(0)	40	(0)	40	14	28
Werner	40	40	(0)	40	(0)	40	(0)	40	(0)	40	(2)	(9)
Zeith	7	7	(0)	7	(0)	7	(0)	7	(0)	7	7	67
Elementary Total	7927	7927	(0)	7927	(0)	7927	(0)	7927	(0)	7927	11	(20)
Stevens	305	300	(5)	333	(17)	270	(17)	279	(17)	179	(92)	(181)
Beitz	507	528	(20)	504	(24)	486	(20)	432	(24)	382	(90)	(146)
CLP MS	287	282	(5)	318	31	324	6	312	(12)	280	(32)	(13)
Kinard	782	785	3	877	32	802	(13)	829	27	810	(19)	25
Ledner	785	783	(2)	783	(2)	730	(33)	730	10	735	(26)	(30)
Lincoln	801	447	(354)	444	(3)	413	(31)	384	(19)	330	(84)	(177)
Preston	812	885	(7)	583	(22)	548	(30)	556	8	524	(32)	(91)
Webster	735	738	(3)	738	(3)	738	(3)	738	(3)	732	(22)	(20)
Middle School Total	4938	4627	(311)	4180	70	4294	(20)	4247	(51)	3352	(200)	(886)
Ford Collins	1748	1774	26	1742	(6)	1764	42	1782	(2)	1718	(64)	(90)
Fossil Ridge	1785	1812	17	1832	30	1834	2	1786	(48)	1788	8	(44)
Poudre	1255	1258	(3)	1243	(12)	1098	(40)	1042	(56)	1017	(25)	(119)
Rocky Mountain	1887	1785	(102)	1708	(77)	1724	16	1710	(14)	1788	38	(17)
Tranah MHS	1474	1440	(34)	1430	(10)	1394	(20)	1394	(40)	1272	(82)	(180)
Wellington MHS	1214	1178	(36)	1141	(34)	1107	(34)	1050	(57)	989	(31)	(200)
Middle High School Total	9383	9222	(161)	8986	(397)	8941	(45)	8479	(504)	6818	(200)	(1564)
Centennial	100	98	(2)	102	4	104	2	104	0	101	(3)	3
Polars	408	410	2	413	3	407	(6)	408	1	412	4	2
PCA	93	92	(1)	90	(2)	90	0	90	0	91	1	(1)
PSD Global Academy	224	185	(39)	183	(2)	189	6	193	4	194	1	9
PSD Options	121	111	(10)	114	3	124	10	133	9	133	0	22
Tranah Pathways	50	50	(0)	54	4	59	5	64	5	67	3	17
NEXT	40	50	10	40	(1)	50	10	60	10	77	6	27
Other Total	1847	880	(967)	1495	3	1332	27	1481	23	1470	14	19
District Total	23,913	24,358	(445)	23,821	(92)	23,485	(110)	22,971	(434)	22,335	(636)	(1524)
Percentage Changes			-2.61%		-2.21%		-1.75%		-1.85%		-1.90%	-7.49%

Projections for Poudre High School include students admitted at OpenHouse/Unlimited

Projections for Poudre High School include students enrolled at Opportunities Unlimited.



CPC data review and core conclusions

2% Annual Decline

Projected for the next 5 years

\$6 million

Revenue loss associated with every 2% drop in enrollment

Boundary changes are insufficient

Declines are generalized across the district

100% Committee Consensus on these facts

Small schools and elementary levels are disproportionately impacted by fixed costs.

Grade-Level Pipeline Comparison

1,934



5th graders
2026 projection

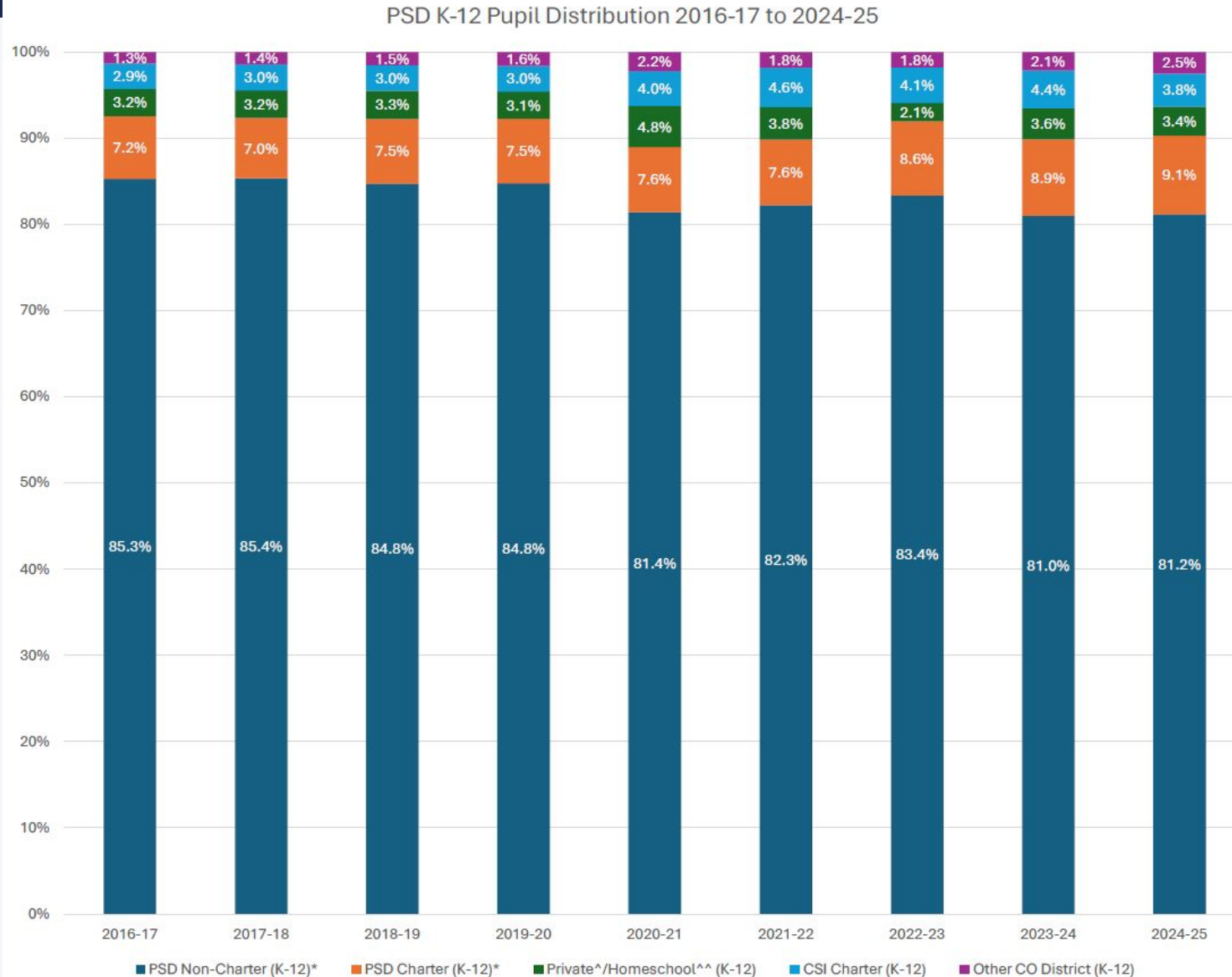
1,442



Kindergarten
2026 projection

The 500 student gap highlights the shrinking pipeline.

9 out of 10 choose a PSD school



**9.1% PSD Charter + 81.2%
PSD School = 9 in 10
students in a PSD school**



10,539 Open Seats

TOTAL CAPACITY

34,105

Total student seats available across 49 district schools.

PROJECTED ENROLLMENT

23,566

Average projected student enrollment for 2025–2030.

EXCESS CAPACITY

10,539

Unutilized or open seats remaining across the district.



17 underutilized buildings

CRITICAL UNDER-UTILIZATION

9 Schools

Operating at less than 50% capacity utilization in 2025.

LOW UTILIZATION

8 Schools

Operating at less than 60% capacity utilization in 2025.

EFFICIENCY TARGET

75-100%

The standard target efficiency range applied by the State of Colorado (BEST guidelines) and local districts.



Fewer, Fuller Schools Means More Equitable Opportunities for All Students

Impact of Enrollment Trends Principal Feedback

- **Erosion of Essential Support Services:** Principals report that declining enrollment has already forced significant cuts to student direct supports, including paraprofessionals, interventionists, and mental health counselors.
- **Reduced Programming and Increased Ratios:** Budget constraints are leading to higher student-to-teacher ratios and the reduction of "Specials" (Art, Music, PE) and Gifted & Talented (GT) programming.
- **The "Growth" Advantage:** Conversely, principals indicated that increased enrollment would allow them to stabilize staffing, expand specialized services, and provide more robust educational offerings for all students.

Current State- Fiscal Stewardship

Operating small schools



Smaller Schools Have More Limited Programming and Staffing Constraints

Comparative Staffing & Budget Analysis

Resource Category	School A: 260 Students (Small)	School B: 390 Students (Moderate)
Size Factor / Tracks	2-track K-5 (21-26/class)	3 track K-5 (17-25/class)
Specials & Media	40% Art, Music, PE 40% Media Specialist	100% Art, Music, PE 100% Media Specialist
Admin & Support	50% Assistant Principal, 100% Principal, 100% Counselor	100% Assistant Principal, 100% Principal, 100% Counselor, 100% ELD
Interventionists	1.0 FTE Interventionist, 10% GT teacher	2.0 FTE Interventionists, 50% GT teacher
Classified Support	100% Office Mgr, 60% Secretary / 40% Health Tech, 4 Paraprofessionals	100% Office Mgr, 100% Secretary, 100% Health Tech Asst, 7 Paraprofessionals
Operating Budget	\$40,000 budget & <.05% reserves	\$55,000 budget & 6.5% reserves

Small Schools Cost More to Operate

Small School Supports					
in millions					
	Size	Tier 2	Tier 3	Total	
FY23	5.0	-	-	5.0	
FY24	6.7	-	-	6.7	
FY25	6.7	-	-	6.7	
FY26	8.1	0.6	0.5	9.2	
FY27	4.1	1.3	3.0	8.4	

Small Schools Cost More to Operate

Small Schools Support Funding

How \$8,408,145 is distributed across PSD schools

CHOICE SCHOOLS

\$3,139,596 · 37.3%

5 schools

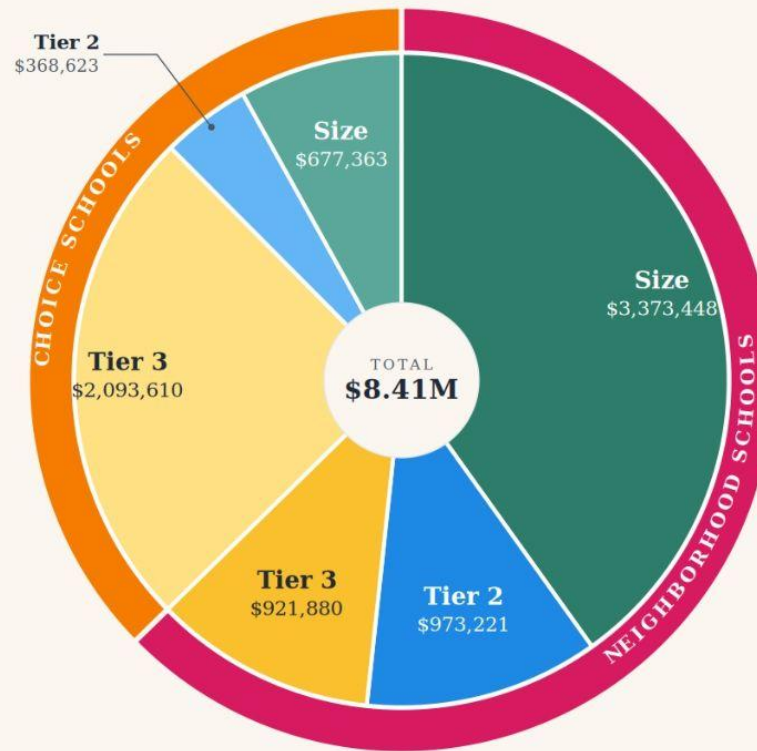
- Centennial HS
- Harris Bilingual
- PSD Global Academy
- Polaris ELS
- Poudre Community Academy

NEIGHBORHOOD SCHOOLS

\$5,268,549 · 62.7%

28 schools

- Bacon Elementary
- Bamford Elementary
- Bauder Elementary
- Beattie Elementary
- Bennett Elementary
- Blevins Middle School
- Boltz Middle School
- Cache La Poudre Elementary
- Cache La Poudre Middle School
- Dunn Elementary
- Irish Elementary
- Johnson Elementary
- Kruse Elementary
- Laurel Elementary
- Lincoln Middle School
- Linton Elementary
- Lopez Elementary
- McGraw Elementary
- Mountain Schools
- O'Dea Elementary
- Olander Elementary
- Preston Middle School
- Putnam Elementary
- Rice Elementary
- Shepardson Elementary
- Timnath Middle School
- Wellington Middle School
- Werner Elementary



CPC- Scenario Development Team

June - September 2026

Data informed approach

The Scenario Development Teams have been studying a regional analysis to guide our work.



Regional Analysis

The Regional Analysis reflects a target to reduce the number of open seats in a particular region and achieve a healthier utilization for more schools in the region.

- Some regions have more open seats than other regions.
- Some regions are projected to decline in enrollment more than others.
- Some levels (ES, MS, HS) are projected to decline more than other levels in enrollment.

Regional Analysis of Empty Seats

The regional analysis has been an anchor document for our work.

10,539

10,539 Open Seats

1. **Average Enrollment projection 2025-2030**

- Regional analysis takes an average of the projections
- 5 year projections indicate a ~2% decline annually.
- Average open seats:
 - i. Elementary: 4,843
 - ii. Middle: 2,538
 - iii. High: 2,777
 - iv. M/H: 284

- ### 2. **National Standard Capacity (NSC):** Number of open seats is based on a reduced threshold already
- NSC is 80% of the capacity.
 - This allows space for programming (ECE, Center-based).
 - The actual number of open seats would be higher (RIC) if we didn't choose to provide space for those specialized programs.

- ### 3. **We have space for 34,105 students which includes additional programming. We need space for 23,566 students.**



District Region Totals

District Region Totals ➔	Total Schools	15	7	15	12	49
	Total Sum of Capacities (NSC)	8,211	5,529	12,259	8,106	34,105
	Total Sum of Average Enrollment 2025 to 2030	4,199	3,780	9,239	6,347	23,566
	Total Utilization (Total Avg Enrollment/ Total Capacity)	51.1%	68.4%	75.4%	78.3%	69.1%
	Total Open Seats (Total Capacity - Total Average Enrollment)	4,012	1,748	3,020	1,759	10,539
	Minimum seats to close to get region to 80%	2,962	803	710	172	4,648

Panel Q&A



What can our future look like?